

INFANTRY FIREPOWER

Although the modern assault rifle is a highly capable weapon, it lacks sufficient firepower to support infantry fighting on their own, and for this reason portable weapons with greater firepower were developed. The light machine-gun (LMG) is one of the oldest support weapons, capable of providing sustained automatic fire. At the next level is the grenade launcher, followed by the mortar, which provides infantry with miniaturized artillery. Portable anti-tank devices have also proved highly successful – ranging from the light RPG-7V to the just-portable MILAN, which fires missiles that the operator guides by wire to avoid defensive countermeasures.

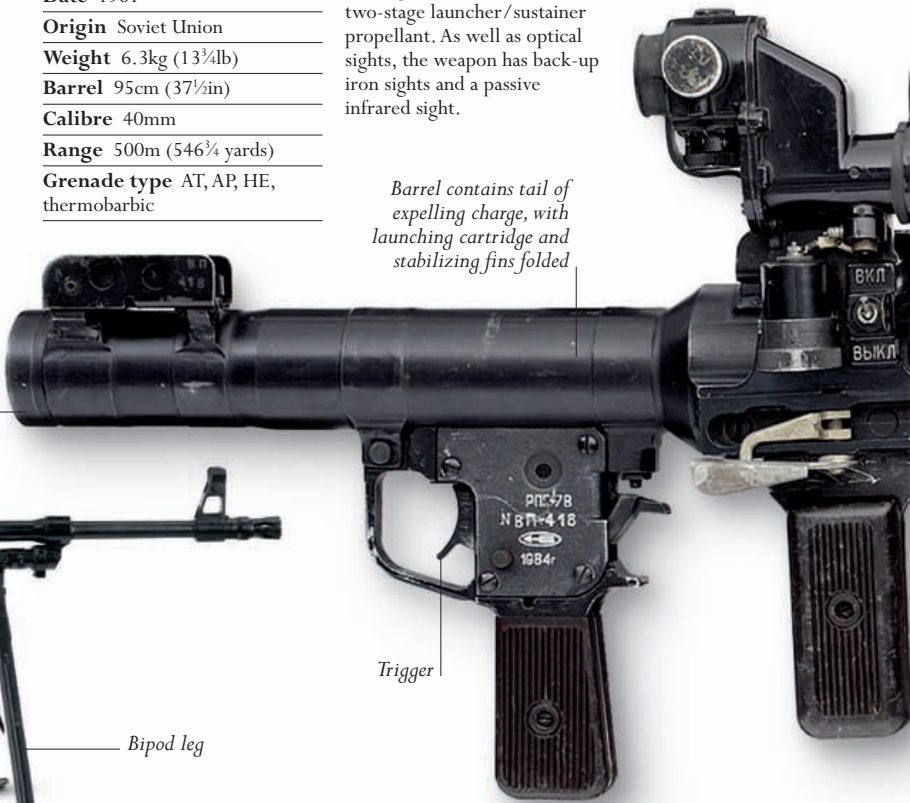


▲ PKM
Date 1969
Origin Soviet Union
Weight 7.5kg (16½lb)
Barrel 64.5cm (25¼in)
Calibre 7.62mm × 54R

A general-purpose machine-gun (GPMG), the PKM is gas-operated, belt-fed, and air-cooled. It is an improved variant of the Mikhail Kalashnikov-designed PK. The butt plate is hinged and contains a cleaning kit.

▼ RPG-7V
Date 1961
Origin Soviet Union
Weight 6.3kg (13¾lb)
Barrel 95cm (37¼in)
Calibre 40mm
Range 500m (546¾ yards)
Grenade type AT, AP, HE, thermobarbic

The shoulder-launched RPG-7 fires a projectile with a two-stage launcher/sustainer propellant. As well as optical sights, the weapon has back-up iron sights and a passive infrared sight.



Barrel contains tail of expelling charge, with launching cartridge and stabilizing fins folded

Trigger



Missile exhaust tube

► MILAN ANTI-TANK MISSILE
Date 1972
Origin France, West Germany
Weight (Loaded) 34kg (75lb)
Length 1.2m (4ft)
Calibre 125mm
Armour penetration 650mm (25½in)

The MILAN is an anti-tank weapon that enables an operator to guide the missile to its target via signals sent along long, thin wires attached to the missile. Although many MILANs are vehicle-mounted, they can be deployed by a two-man infantry crew.



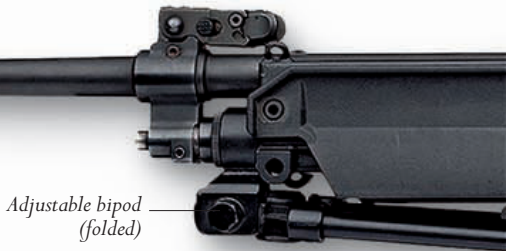
Retractable butt stock (extended)

Ammunition belt container

Bipod leg

◀ FN MINIMI
Date 1975
Origin Belgium
Weight 6.83kg (15lb)
Barrel 46.5cm (18¼in)
Calibre 5.56 × 45mm

An outstanding gas-operated, air-cooled light machine-gun, the Minimi has been adopted by the British Army and the US Army, amongst others, where it has been designated the M249 Squad Automatic Weapon (SAW).



Adjustable bipod (folded)